

INTEROFFICE COMMUNICATION
San Mateo Police Department
Investigations Services

Date: February 10, 2021

To: All Department Personnel

From: Lt. Todd Mefford

Re: **ALPR OPERATIONAL GUIDELINES**

Sergeant	_____
Lieutenant	_____
Field Ops Captain	_____
Support Captain	_____
Chief	_____

This memo serves to provide department personnel with an overview of our various ALPR platforms and guidelines when access, utilization and response to real-time ALPR notifications are determined to be necessary. SMPD utilizes camera hardware systems through Flock Safety and PIPs Technology to capture real-time license plate data. Personnel will receive ALPR notifications from Flock and BOSS in real time when logged into those platforms. Officers also have access to the NCRIC and Vigilant Solutions platforms to access digital license plate data for investigative purposes.

In no case shall the ALPR Platforms be used for any purpose other than legitimate law enforcement or public safety purpose. In accordance with the California Values Act, ALPR data may not be used for the purposes of immigration enforcement or other similar duties.

Management, Maintenance and Administration of the ALPR Platforms:

The Support Services Captain, or their designee, will have overall management responsibility for the ALPR Platforms. The Investigations Lieutenant will chair the ALPR Steering Committee and Subcommittee. System Administrators for the ALPR platforms will be the Investigation Lieutenant and Sergeant. Issues with the fixed ALPR cameras should be immediately brought to the Investigations Lieutenant or his/her designated Sergeant. Daytime Patrol Lieutenant will have oversight of ALPR operations in Patrol to include vehicle ALPR cameras, connectivity or software issues, mobile traffic trailers. Any camera or software functionality issues will be brought to the Patrol Lieutenant, or his/her designee, who will work to resolve the issue.

ALPR System Overview:

ALPR platforms are emerging as an important investigative tool and the department is expanding access to this technology. Officers and Dispatchers currently have access to the NCRIC for BOSS ALPR data and will now have access to the Flock Safety and Vigilant Solutions ALPR data for expanded investigative capability. They are required to receive departmental approved training before accessing these ALPR platforms.

- 1) PIP's Technology: Cameras currently on four patrol vehicles and two trailers that collect data and upload it via Pagis software into the BOSS platform. BOSS is maintained in the NCRIC cloud server. We log into BOSS to access our, and other agencies, ALPR data.

When logged into BOSS, Officers can receive real-time notifications of hits from our PIPs Technology cameras.

- 2) Flock Safety: In contract with Flock Safety for 22 ALPR cameras. 19 at fixed locations monitoring vehicles entering and leaving the city and three on three individual trailers. Our Flock Safety ALPR cameras capture digital license plate data and upload it to their cloud server. Personnel log in to the Flock Safety website to access our data as well as the data from other agencies that have chosen to share with us. When logged in, Officers can receive real-time notifications of hits from our Flock Safety cameras.
- 3) Vigilant Solutions: We do not own or operate any Vigilant cameras. We have an account with and access to their search platform for ALPR data collected by other agencies utilizing their technology. Personnel that have completed the department approved training can request access to the search platform through their immediate supervisor. Vigilant is a much larger company and contains a large amount of ALPR data.

Actionable Information:

It is the policy of this department to consider appropriate response to actionable information such as Stolen Vehicles, Felony Vehicle (wanted person or vehicle) or Missing Persons. ALPR platforms also hit on vehicles in DOJ/NCIC related to sexual offenders, protection orders, supervised release, violent offenders, gang or terrorism related vehicles and stolen or lost license plates. These hits are not actionable without additional information, i.e. matches description of suspect vehicle or registered owner is recognized as an investigative lead in a crime.

Accessing ALPR Technology and databases:

Personnel must comply with department Lexipol Policy 462 and SOP 205 when accessing any of the ALPR platforms. Sharing your login or password is prohibited. Personnel shall use and access the ALPR databases for authorized investigative purposes only. When accessing any of the ALPR databases, personnel shall:

- 1) Include the sign-on information (username / password)
- 2) Required search information by End-User (case number, justification for search, etc.)

Procedure:

Standard Operating Procedure for our current PIPs/BOSS ALPR platform will be used for both for Flock Safety hits as well. With the introduction of fixed ALPR cameras, officers that follow up on hits they receive from fixed ALPR locations should be in the Beat of the ALPR hit location before considering investigation to ensure a timely response to the information. The following procedure will be followed:

- Officers logged into ALPR platforms will receive hits notifications when a flagged vehicle in DOJ/NCIC is captured by an ALPR System.
- Officers should confirm and compare that the plate data and photo shown on the search platform are the same (not a misread)
- Advise Dispatch over the air of the ALPR hit, location, and fixed or mobile. Examples:

“A12 Fixed ALPR hit at Poplar & Amphlett” or “A12, Mobile ALPR hit at 3rd and Norfolk.”

- Advise Dispatch if you have visual of the vehicle.
- Officers will not coordinate car to car without first notifying Dispatch to ensure proper supervision of Officer activity.
- Dispatch will query the license plate and will provide voice return over the air.
- Dispatch will ensure a Watch Sergeant is aware of the ALPR hit over the radio and the Sergeant or Supervisor will acknowledge over the air.
- Officers will take appropriate enforcement action.

Training:

Prior to accessing the ALPR platforms, personnel will complete the department approved training as outlined in Lexipol Policy 462.

Fixed ALPR Camera Locations:

Fixed Locations:

- WB Peninsula from Airport Blvd
- NB N Bayshore Blvd approaching Peninsula
- SB 101 exit onto Poplar
- SB 101 onramp from Poplar & Amphlett
- EB 4th Ave Humboldt toward the overpass and SB 101
- WB 3rd Ave from the overpass approaching Humboldt
- SB 101 to WB 3rd Ave off ramp onto WB 3rd Ave
- SB Norfolk approaching Mariners Island Blvd
- EB & WB Hillsdale west of Saratoga
- WB Concar Dr. from Delaware
- NB Norfolk approaching 3rd Ave
- SB Norfolk leaving 3rd Ave
- WB Kehoe at Dix St
- SB Lindberg approaching 3rd Ave
- NB Norfolk approaching Hillsdale
- SB El Camino Real south of 17th for EB/WB SR-92 onramps
- NB 1900 block of El Camino Real prior to EB/WB onramps to SR-92
- Delaware @ 19th onramp to EB SR-92

Trailers:

- Two PIPs traffic trailers
- Three Flock Safety traffic trailers